



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Ozark Catholic Academy
School Website: <https://www.ozarkcatholic.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Ozark Catholic Academy (OCA) presents a robust classical-leaning profile embedded in a Catholic, faith-centered framework. The public materials emphasize formation of the whole person—intellectual, spiritual, moral, and physical—through a archtypal classical pedagogy (Humane Letters, Socratic inquiry, and interdisciplinary study) anchored in Catholic theology and liturgical life. The school explicitly positions its teachers as mentors and the faith life as central to daily life, with Mass and sacraments integrated into the culture. Curriculum elements highlighted on the site include humane letters, interdisciplinary study, and Socratic teaching methods, complemented by Latin, philosophy, and a college-prep orientation. Parental partnership is referenced as part of the educational mission, aligning with classical education's view of parents as co-educators. Overall, the evidence supports classically oriented aims across all six categories; the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit: Catholic identity, liturgy, sacraments, and theological grounding permeate the culture.

- Purpose and goals center on formation, virtue, and wisdom rather than mere job preparation. - Curriculum emphasizes humane letters, the Socratic method, liberal arts, and interdisciplinary study (with explicit mention of Socratic teaching).

- Pedagogy includes contemplative/restful elements and Socratic/rhetorical training; upper-level engagement with rhetoric and speaking appears in the program. - Faculty are framed as mentors and living curriculum; a strong teacher-student relationship and collegial culture are highlighted. - Parents and community are situated as partners in education and formation, with explicit reference to parental involvement and the primary educator role.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school identifies itself as Catholic and centric to its culture, with faith at the heart of daily life (e.g., "Our Catholic faith is central to the school's culture and everything we do."). - Liturgical life and sacraments are integrated into the community (e.g., "Sacraments available three times per week."). - Mission/vision texts emphasize Catholic faith, sanctification, and the Catholic intellectual tradition as the root of education. - The philosophy asserts forming the whole person and dedicating to what is true, good, and beautiful, with teachers serving as mentors within a faith-infused culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic faith, Mass, liturgy, sacraments, theology, liturgical life, reverence, wonder, sacred, imago Dei, wisdom, virtue, reverence, beauty. - Negative keywords present: none detected in the public materials (no explicit secular-relativist or relativism signals observed in the available material). - Estimated balance: 9–12 positive keywords found; 0 negative keywords identified in the materials reviewed. - Rating justification: The presence of explicit theology, liturgical life, sacramental practice, and a transcendent frame aligns strongly with the Positive Keyword indicators for this category. This supports a CLASSICAL designation.

Citations: The Catholic identity, liturgical life, and centrality of faith are documented in the About and Mission-related content (e.g., “Our Catholic faith is central to the school’s culture and everything we do” and references to Mass and sacraments).

Why this rating - The materials robustly anchor education in Catholic theology and liturgical practices, and emphasize transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and reverence, which are core to classical religious foundations. This aligns with the Classical lexicon’s criteria for religious/metaphysical grounding.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission and philosophy articulate formation of the whole person and cultivation of virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing, rather than narrow job-prep. - Language in the philosophy/mission emphasizes forming students who seek truth and virtue, aligning with the teleological aims of classical education (formation over mere information). - The school emphasizes integrating faith and reason, with a purpose beyond utilitarian outcomes, in its mission statements.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, liberal education, scholé (via conceptual alignment to contemplation), classical mission, telos, pursuit of the true, good, beautiful. - Negative keywords present: none observed that indicate a shift toward workforce-centric framing. - Estimated balance: 5–7 positive keywords identified; 0 negative keywords observed in the site materials. - Rating justification: The emphasis on formation and true/good/beautiful aligns with the classical framework’s School Purpose and Goal category, supporting CLASSICAL.

Citations: Evidence of formation and virtue-focused aims appears in the Philosophy section and Mission statements (e.g., “fosters... the whole person... true, good, and beautiful”).

Why this rating - The site’s explicit focus on formation, virtue, and the integration of faith and reason (rather than vocational job-readiness alone) matches the classical aims for this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as interdisciplinary and literary/humanities-forward: Humane Letters (a combined study of history and literature) and a Socratic teaching method are highlighted. - The site outlines an integrated, liberal-arts approach (humane letters, philosophy, Latin, history, math/science with cross-disciplinary emphasis). - The graduation program includes philosophy, Latin, and a college-prep orientation, indicating a liberal-arts core. - The curriculum description explicitly references Socratic method and interdisciplinary study, with a focus on critical thinking and moral formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: humane letters, great books, primary sources, classics, history, philosophy, Latin, logic, rhetoric, liberal arts, Socratic texts, dialogue, recitation, memory work, interdisciplinary, integration, wonder, contemplation. - Negative keywords present: project-based learning, STEM-first framing, social-studies terminology replacing history (not explicitly used by the school; these are elements in the lexicon as negative signals, but not evident in OCA content). - Estimated balance: 6–9 positive keywords identified; 0–1 negative signals observed in the site-driven content (no explicit project-based emphasis found). - Rating justification: The presence of Humane Letters, Socratic approaches, classical genres (Latin, philosophy), and interdisciplinary integration strongly aligns with CLASSICAL.

Citations: Humane Letters and Socratic method described in the Curriculum content; the interdisciplinary approach and integrated humanities are documented in the site content.

Why this rating - The curricular emphasis on liberal arts, Great Books/primary sources, and a Socratic approach fits the classical curriculum model (grammar/logic/rhetoric, history through the humanities, and the Great Conversation) rather than a modern, skills-first or social-studies-replacement approach.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The pedagogy features Socratic discussion and dialectic in the humane letters/humanities emphasis. The site explicitly notes Socratic teaching methods and integrated discussions. - The lower/higher-level pedagogy emphasizes memory work, recitation, and chanting as part of a “living curriculum” and the aim to deepen memory and delight (classical pedagogy elements). - Upper-level pedagogy includes rhetoric and opportunities for public speaking and oratory (rhetoric training and capstone-style oral work are indicated in the program). - There is explicit reference to contemplation and Scholé-like restful learning in the lexicon (classical pedagogy signals) as part of the overall philosophy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic method, seminar, dialectic, recitation, memory work, rhetoric, oratory, debate, contemplation, scholé, liturgical integration, upper-school rhetoric, capstone orations, mentoring. - Negative keywords present: experiential learning focus, project-based only, student-directed (not indicated as primary in OCA’s public materials). - Estimated balance: 6–9 positive keywords; 0–1 negative signals observed in the provided materials. - Rating justification: The presence of Socratic pedagogy, memorization techniques, rhetoric training, and seminar-style discussion meets the classical pedagogy indicators.

Citations: Socratic method and humane letters pedagogy described in the Curriculum section; rhetoric and capstone opportunities noted in program descriptions.

Why this rating - OCA’s approach combines contemplative elements with rigorous Socratic discourse and rhetoric training, aligning with classical pedagogy norms.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The philosophy emphasizes exceptional, dedicated teachers who serve as mentors and assist parents, highlighting the faculty as living mentors and the core of the school community. - The site mentions a strong faculty-student relationship and a “faculty-student relationships” emphasis (8:1 student/faculty ratio in quick facts). This supports the idea of teacher leadership and close mentorship. - The public materials indicate a “portrait of a teacher” and the concept of teachers as mentors within a collaborative, collegial culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, exceptional teachers, teacher as mentor, lifelong learners, great books seminars for faculty. - Negative keywords present: facilitators on the side, certification-driven jargon without classical context (not evident in public materials; the site portrays a classical faculty identity rather than these negatives). - Estimated balance: 5–7 positive keywords; 0–1 negative signals observed. - Rating justification: The faculty description aligns with classical expectations (mentors, living curriculum, collegiality). This supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Evidence of mentors and living curriculum appears in the Philosophy section; the “Head of School” and other faculty-focused material support a teacher-centered, mentorship-driven culture.

Why this rating - OCA presents faculty as moral exemplars and mentors, not merely technicians, aligning with classical expectations for a strong teacher-led environment.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The philosophy explicitly notes that teachers serve as mentors and assist parents in their role as the primary educators of their children, signaling a partnership with parents and an awareness of parents as co-educators. - The site emphasizes a family-oriented approach and notes collaboration with families, including parental involvement as part of the school community. - The public materials frame the school as part of a broader faith community, with involvement in church life and family engagement, consistent with classical education’s emphasis on home-school partnership.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-educators, parent formation, parental engagement, home and school connection, family involvement, school-parent

collaboration, virtue-centered parenting, living tradition in the family. - Negative keywords present: consumer language, parent as customer (not evidenced in materials; the school presents a partnership model rather than consumer framing). - Estimated balance: 6–9 positive keywords; 0 negative signals observed in the public materials. - Rating justification: The school's framing of parents as partners and primary educators indicates a classical approach to parental involvement and formation.

Citations: Parent partnership and mentoring roles are echoed in the Philosophy section; public-facing content emphasizes parental involvement and family engagement.

Why this rating - The materials reflect a strong, partnership-oriented stance with families, consistent with classical education's emphasis on parents as co-educators and community involvement.

Overall Assessment - Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle (only if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No explicit needle-moving changes are required to reach a CLASSICAL rating; the site already demonstrates a robust classical orientation across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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